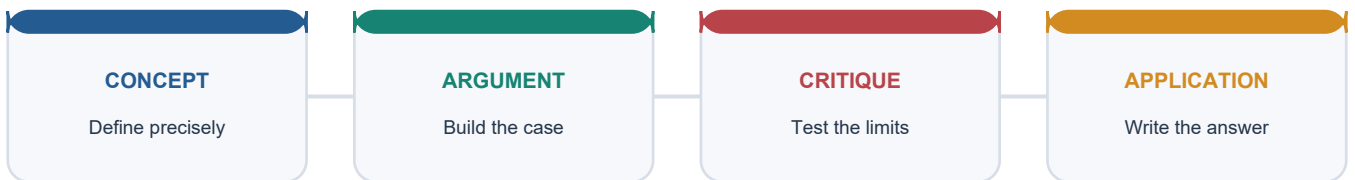


SOLVED PRACTICE WORKBOOK

Punctuation and Capitalisation - Qualifying English Solved Practice Workbook

UPSC complete learning session | Foundation to advanced | Concepts, evidence, practice and answer writing

LEARNING PATH



Deterministic fallback visual: move from precise concepts through argument and critique to exam application.

Source order: repository knowledge -> official current linkage -> clearly marked analysis. No fabricated PYQs or statistics.

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BASIC MCQS / REMEDIATION

Diagnostic set - Questions 1-16

Q1. Foundation rule - introductory comma: Which statement is safest and most accurate for formal examination English?

A. Use a comma after a substantial introductory phrase or clause. B. Place a comma between subject and verb. C. Never punctuate an introductory clause. D. Use a semicolon after every opening phrase.

Q2. Foundation rule - coordinated clauses: Which statement is safest and most accurate for formal examination English?

A. A comma alone is sufficient. B. Use comma plus a coordinating conjunction between independent clauses. C. A colon is mandatory before and. D. Delete all punctuation.

Q3. Foundation rule - comma splice: Which statement is safest and most accurate for formal examination English?

A. Add another comma. B. Replace it with an apostrophe. C. Repair a comma splice with a full stop, semicolon, or comma plus coordinator. D. Keep it because the clauses are related.

Q4. Foundation rule - restrictive clause: Which statement is safest and most accurate for formal examination English?

A. All who-clauses take commas. B. That-clauses are always parenthetical. C. Meaning does not affect commas. D. Do not surround an identifying restrictive clause with commas.

Q5. Foundation rule - non-restrictive clause: Which statement is safest and most accurate for formal examination English?

A. Set removable supplementary information off with paired commas. B. Use one opening comma only. C. Replace commas with apostrophes. D. Use that after every comma.

Q6. Foundation rule - semicolon: Which statement is safest and most accurate for formal examination English?

A. It introduces every simple list. B. A semicolon can join closely related independent clauses. C. It can divide a verb from its object. D. It is identical to an apostrophe.

Q7. Foundation rule - colon: Which statement is safest and most accurate for formal examination English?

A. A colon must follow every verb. B. A colon can join unrelated fragments. C. Use a colon after a complete announcing clause to introduce explanation or a list. D. A colon is required before every quotation.

Q8. Foundation rule - apostrophe: Which statement is safest and most accurate for formal examination English?

A. Write NGO's for the plural NGOs. B. Its always means it is. C. Regular plural possession adds 's after s. D. Use apostrophes for possession or omission, not ordinary plurals.

Q9. Foundation rule - quotation: Which statement is safest and most accurate for formal examination English?

A. Direct speech uses quotation marks; indirect speech does not. B. Indirect questions retain question word order and a question mark. C. Every reported statement needs quotation marks. D. Quotation conventions are identical in all style systems.

Q10. Foundation rule - hyphen: Which statement is safest and most accurate for formal examination English?

A. Hyphenate every adverb ending in -ly. B. Hyphenate a compound modifier before a noun when it improves clarity. C. Always hyphenate after the linking verb. D. Never hyphenate number compounds.

Q11. Foundation rule - capitalisation: Which statement is safest and most accurate for formal examination English?

A. Capitalise every important noun. B. Never capitalise Parliament. C. Capitalise proper names and formal institutional names, not generic roles. D. Always capitalise minister in generic use.

Q12. Foundation rule - accepted styles: Which statement is safest and most accurate for formal examination English?

A. Only the serial comma is grammatical. B. The serial comma is always wrong. C. Consistency never matters. D. Accept a consistent serial comma or no serial comma unless ambiguity decides.

Q13. Editing decision - introductory comma: Which statement is safest and most accurate for formal examination English?

A. Use a comma after a substantial introductory phrase or clause. B. Place a comma between subject and verb. C. Never punctuate an introductory clause. D. Use a semicolon after every opening phrase.

Q14. Editing decision - coordinated clauses: Which statement is safest and most accurate for formal examination English?

A. A comma alone is sufficient. B. Use comma plus a coordinating conjunction between independent clauses. C. A colon is mandatory before and. D. Delete all punctuation.

Q15. Editing decision - comma splice: Which statement is safest and most accurate for formal examination English?

A. Add another comma. B. Replace it with an apostrophe. C. Repair a comma splice with a full stop, semicolon, or comma plus coordinator. D. Keep it because the clauses are related.

Q16. Editing decision - restrictive clause: Which statement is safest and most accurate for formal examination English?

A. All who-clauses take commas. B. That-clauses are always parenthetical. C. Meaning does not affect commas. D. Do not surround an identifying restrictive clause with commas.

Graded set - Questions 17-32

Q17. Editing decision - non-restrictive clause: Which statement is safest and most accurate for formal examination English?

A. Set removable supplementary information off with paired commas. B. Use one opening comma only. C. Replace commas with apostrophes. D. Use that after every comma.

Q18. Editing decision - semicolon: Which statement is safest and most accurate for formal examination English?

A. It introduces every simple list. B. A semicolon can join closely related independent clauses. C. It can divide a verb from its object. D. It is identical to an apostrophe.

Q19. Editing decision - colon: Which statement is safest and most accurate for formal examination English?

A. A colon must follow every verb. B. A colon can join unrelated fragments. C. Use a colon after a complete announcing clause to introduce explanation or a list. D. A colon is required before every quotation.

Q20. Editing decision - apostrophe: Which statement is safest and most accurate for formal examination English?

A. Write NGO's for the plural NGOs. B. Its always means it is. C. Regular plural possession adds 's after s. D. Use apostrophes for possession or omission, not ordinary plurals.

Q21. Editing decision - quotation: Which statement is safest and most accurate for formal examination English?

A. Direct speech uses quotation marks; indirect speech does not. B. Indirect questions retain question word order and a question mark. C. Every reported statement needs quotation marks. D. Quotation conventions are identical in all style systems.

Q22. Editing decision - hyphen: Which statement is safest and most accurate for formal examination English?

A. Hyphenate every adverb ending in -ly. B. Hyphenate a compound modifier before a noun when it improves clarity. C. Always hyphenate after the linking verb. D. Never hyphenate number compounds.

Q23. Editing decision - capitalisation: Which statement is safest and most accurate for formal examination English?

A. Capitalise every important noun. B. Never capitalise Parliament. C. Capitalise proper names and formal institutional names, not generic roles. D. Always capitalise minister in generic use.

Q24. Editing decision - accepted styles: Which statement is safest and most accurate for formal examination English?

A. Only the serial comma is grammatical. B. The serial comma is always wrong. C. Consistency never matters. D. Accept a consistent serial comma or no serial comma unless ambiguity decides.

Q25. Timed-paper choice - introductory comma: Which statement is safest and most accurate for formal examination English?

A. Use a comma after a substantial introductory phrase or clause. B. Place a comma between subject and verb. C. Never punctuate an introductory clause. D. Use a semicolon after every opening phrase.

Q26. Timed-paper choice - coordinated clauses: Which statement is safest and most accurate for formal examination English?

A. A comma alone is sufficient. B. Use comma plus a coordinating conjunction between independent clauses. C. A colon is mandatory before and. D. Delete all punctuation.

Q27. Timed-paper choice - comma splice: Which statement is safest and most accurate for formal examination English?

A. Add another comma. B. Replace it with an apostrophe. C. Repair a comma splice with a full stop, semicolon, or comma plus coordinator. D. Keep it because the clauses are related.

Q28. Timed-paper choice - restrictive clause: Which statement is safest and most accurate for formal examination English?

A. All who-clauses take commas. B. That-clauses are always parenthetical. C. Meaning does not affect commas. D. Do not surround an identifying restrictive clause with commas.

Q29. Timed-paper choice - non-restrictive clause: Which statement is safest and most accurate for formal examination English?

A. Set removable supplementary information off with paired commas. B. Use one opening comma only. C. Replace commas with apostrophes. D. Use that after every comma.

Q30. Timed-paper choice - semicolon: Which statement is safest and most accurate for formal examination English?

A. It introduces every simple list. B. A semicolon can join closely related independent clauses. C. It can divide a verb from its object. D. It is identical to an apostrophe.

Q31. Timed-paper choice - colon: Which statement is safest and most accurate for formal examination English?

A. A colon must follow every verb. B. A colon can join unrelated fragments. C. Use a colon after a complete announcing clause to introduce explanation or a list. D. A colon is required before every quotation.

Q32. Timed-paper choice - apostrophe: Which statement is safest and most accurate for formal examination English?

A. Write NGO's for the plural NGOs. B. Its always means it is. C. Regular plural possession adds 's after s. D. Use apostrophes for possession or omission, not ordinary plurals.

Remedial and timed set - Questions 33-48

Q33. Timed-paper choice - quotation: Which statement is safest and most accurate for formal examination English?

A. Direct speech uses quotation marks; indirect speech does not. B. Indirect questions retain question word order and a question mark. C. Every reported statement needs quotation marks. D. Quotation conventions are identical in all style systems.

Q34. Timed-paper choice - hyphen: Which statement is safest and most accurate for formal examination English?

A. Hyphenate every adverb ending in -ly. B. Hyphenate a compound modifier before a noun when it improves clarity. C. Always hyphenate after the linking verb. D. Never hyphenate number compounds.

Q35. Timed-paper choice - capitalisation: Which statement is safest and most accurate for formal examination English?

A. Capitalise every important noun. B. Never capitalise Parliament. C. Capitalise proper names and formal institutional names, not generic roles. D. Always capitalise minister in generic use.

Q36. Timed-paper choice - accepted styles: Which statement is safest and most accurate for formal examination English?

A. Only the serial comma is grammatical. B. The serial comma is always wrong. C. Consistency never matters. D. Accept a consistent serial comma or no serial comma unless ambiguity decides.

Q37. Hostile variation check - introductory comma: Which statement is safest and most accurate for formal examination English?

A. Use a comma after a substantial introductory phrase or clause. B. Place a comma between subject and verb. C. Never punctuate an introductory clause. D. Use a semicolon after every opening phrase.

Q38. Hostile variation check - coordinated clauses: Which statement is safest and most accurate for formal examination English?

A. A comma alone is sufficient. B. Use comma plus a coordinating conjunction between independent clauses. C. A colon is mandatory before and. D. Delete all punctuation.

Q39. Hostile variation check - comma splice: Which statement is safest and most accurate for formal examination English?

A. Add another comma. B. Replace it with an apostrophe. C. Repair a comma splice with a full stop, semicolon, or comma plus coordinator. D. Keep it because the clauses are related.

Q40. Hostile variation check - restrictive clause: Which statement is safest and most accurate for formal examination English?

A. All who-clauses take commas. B. That-clauses are always parenthetical. C. Meaning does not affect commas. D. Do not surround an identifying restrictive clause with commas.

Q41. Hostile variation check - non-restrictive clause: Which statement is safest and most accurate for formal examination English?

A. Set removable supplementary information off with paired commas. B. Use one opening comma only. C. Replace commas with apostrophes. D. Use that after every comma.

Q42. Hostile variation check - semicolon: Which statement is safest and most accurate for formal examination English?

A. It introduces every simple list. B. A semicolon can join closely related independent clauses. C. It can divide a verb from its object. D. It is identical to an apostrophe.

Q43. Hostile variation check - colon: Which statement is safest and most accurate for formal examination English?

A. A colon must follow every verb. B. A colon can join unrelated fragments. C. Use a colon after a complete announcing clause to introduce explanation or a list. D. A colon is required before every quotation.

Q44. Hostile variation check - apostrophe: Which statement is safest and most accurate for formal examination English?

A. Write NGO's for the plural NGOs. B. Its always means it is. C. Regular plural possession adds 's after s. D. Use apostrophes for possession or omission, not ordinary plurals.

Q45. Hostile variation check - quotation: Which statement is safest and most accurate for formal examination English?

A. Direct speech uses quotation marks; indirect speech does not. B. Indirect questions retain question word order and a question mark. C. Every reported statement needs quotation marks. D. Quotation conventions are identical in all style systems.

Q46. Hostile variation check - hyphen: Which statement is safest and most accurate for formal examination English?

A. Hyphenate every adverb ending in -ly. B. Hyphenate a compound modifier before a noun when it improves clarity. C. Always hyphenate after the linking verb. D. Never hyphenate number compounds.

Q47. Hostile variation check - capitalisation: Which statement is safest and most accurate for formal examination English?

A. Capitalise every important noun. B. Never capitalise Parliament. C. Capitalise proper names and formal institutional names, not generic roles. D. Always capitalise minister in generic use.

Q48. Hostile variation check - accepted styles: Which statement is safest and most accurate for formal examination English?

A. Only the serial comma is grammatical. B. The serial comma is always wrong. C. Consistency never matters. D. Accept a consistent serial comma or no serial comma unless ambiguity decides.

PYQS AND ANSWER PRACTICE

Complete MCQ explanations

Q1. Foundation rule - introductory comma: Which statement is safest and most accurate for formal examination English?

A. Use a comma after a substantial introductory phrase or clause. B. Place a comma between subject and verb. C. Never punctuate an introductory clause. D. Use a semicolon after every opening phrase.

Correct answer: A. The correct option states the governing rule without changing meaning or inventing an absolute.

Q2. Foundation rule - coordinated clauses: Which statement is safest and most accurate for formal examination English?

A. A comma alone is sufficient. B. Use comma plus a coordinating conjunction between independent clauses. C. A colon is mandatory before and. D. Delete all punctuation.

Correct answer: B. The correct option states the governing rule without changing meaning or inventing an absolute.

Q3. Foundation rule - comma splice: Which statement is safest and most accurate for formal examination English?

A. Add another comma. B. Replace it with an apostrophe. C. Repair a comma splice with a full stop, semicolon, or comma plus coordinator. D. Keep it because the clauses are related.

Correct answer: C. The correct option states the governing rule without changing meaning or inventing an absolute.

Q4. Foundation rule - restrictive clause: Which statement is safest and most accurate for formal examination English?

A. All who-clauses take commas. B. That-clauses are always parenthetical. C. Meaning does not affect commas. D. Do not surround an identifying restrictive clause with commas.

Correct answer: D. The correct option states the governing rule without changing meaning or inventing an absolute.

Q5. Foundation rule - non-restrictive clause: Which statement is safest and most accurate for formal examination English?

A. Set removable supplementary information off with paired commas. B. Use one opening comma only. C. Replace commas with apostrophes. D. Use that after every comma.

Correct answer: A. The correct option states the governing rule without changing meaning or inventing an absolute.

Q6. Foundation rule - semicolon: Which statement is safest and most accurate for formal examination English?

A. It introduces every simple list. B. A semicolon can join closely related independent clauses. C. It can divide a verb from its object. D. It is identical to an apostrophe.

Correct answer: B. The correct option states the governing rule without changing meaning or inventing an absolute.

Q7. Foundation rule - colon: Which statement is safest and most accurate for formal examination English?

A. A colon must follow every verb. B. A colon can join unrelated fragments. C. Use a colon after a complete announcing clause to introduce explanation or a list. D. A colon is required before every quotation.

Correct answer: C. A complete clause may end in a verb and still announce what follows.

Q8. Foundation rule - apostrophe: Which statement is safest and most accurate for formal examination English?

A. Write NGO's for the plural NGOs. B. Its always means it is. C. Regular plural possession adds 's after s. D. Use apostrophes for possession or omission, not ordinary plurals.

Correct answer: D. The correct option states the governing rule without changing meaning or inventing an absolute.

Q9. Foundation rule - quotation: Which statement is safest and most accurate for formal examination English?

A. Direct speech uses quotation marks; indirect speech does not. B. Indirect questions retain question word order and a question mark. C. Every reported statement needs quotation marks. D. Quotation conventions are identical in all style systems.

Correct answer: A. British and US terminal-mark placement can differ.

Q10. Foundation rule - hyphen: Which statement is safest and most accurate for formal examination English?

A. Hyphenate every adverb ending in -ly. B. Hyphenate a compound modifier before a noun when it improves clarity. C. Always hyphenate after the linking verb. D. Never hyphenate number compounds.

Correct answer: B. The correct option states the governing rule without changing meaning or inventing an absolute.

Q11. Foundation rule - capitalisation: Which statement is safest and most accurate for formal examination English?

A. Capitalise every important noun. B. Never capitalise Parliament. C. Capitalise proper names and formal institutional names, not generic roles. D. Always capitalise minister in generic use.

Correct answer: C. The correct option states the governing rule without changing meaning or inventing an absolute.

Q12. Foundation rule - accepted styles: Which statement is safest and most accurate for formal examination English?

A. Only the serial comma is grammatical. B. The serial comma is always wrong. C. Consistency never matters. D. Accept a consistent serial comma or no serial comma unless ambiguity decides.

Correct answer: D. The correct option states the governing rule without changing meaning or inventing an absolute.

Q13. Editing decision - introductory comma: Which statement is safest and most accurate for formal examination English?

A. Use a comma after a substantial introductory phrase or clause. B. Place a comma between subject and verb. C. Never punctuate an introductory clause. D. Use a semicolon after every opening phrase.

Correct answer: A. The correct option states the governing rule without changing meaning or inventing an absolute.

Q14. Editing decision - coordinated clauses: Which statement is safest and most accurate for formal examination English?

A. A comma alone is sufficient. B. Use comma plus a coordinating conjunction between independent clauses. C. A colon is mandatory before and. D. Delete all punctuation.

Correct answer: B. The correct option states the governing rule without changing meaning or inventing an absolute.

Q15. Editing decision - comma splice: Which statement is safest and most accurate for formal examination English?

A. Add another comma. B. Replace it with an apostrophe. C. Repair a comma splice with a full stop, semicolon, or comma plus coordinator. D. Keep it because the clauses are related.

Correct answer: C. The correct option states the governing rule without changing meaning or inventing an absolute.

Q16. Editing decision - restrictive clause: Which statement is safest and most accurate for formal examination English?

A. All who-clauses take commas. B. That-clauses are always parenthetical. C. Meaning does not affect commas. D. Do not surround an identifying restrictive clause with commas.

Correct answer: D. The correct option states the governing rule without changing meaning or inventing an absolute.

Q17. Editing decision - non-restrictive clause: Which statement is safest and most accurate for formal examination English?

A. Set removable supplementary information off with paired commas. B. Use one opening comma only. C. Replace commas with apostrophes. D. Use that after every comma.

Correct answer: A. The correct option states the governing rule without changing meaning or inventing an absolute.

Q18. Editing decision - semicolon: Which statement is safest and most accurate for formal examination English?

A. It introduces every simple list. B. A semicolon can join closely related independent clauses. C. It can divide a verb from its object. D. It is identical to an apostrophe.

Correct answer: B. The correct option states the governing rule without changing meaning or inventing an absolute.

Q19. Editing decision - colon: Which statement is safest and most accurate for formal examination English?

A. A colon must follow every verb. B. A colon can join unrelated fragments. C. Use a colon after a complete announcing clause to introduce explanation or a list. D. A colon is required before every quotation.

Correct answer: C. A complete clause may end in a verb and still announce what follows.

Q20. Editing decision - apostrophe: Which statement is safest and most accurate for formal examination English?

A. Write NGO's for the plural NGOs. B. Its always means it is. C. Regular plural possession adds 's after s. D. Use apostrophes for possession or omission, not ordinary plurals.

Correct answer: D. The correct option states the governing rule without changing meaning or inventing an absolute.

Q21. Editing decision - quotation: Which statement is safest and most accurate for formal examination English?

A. Direct speech uses quotation marks; indirect speech does not. B. Indirect questions retain question word order and a question mark. C. Every reported statement needs quotation marks. D. Quotation conventions are identical in all style systems.

Correct answer: A. British and US terminal-mark placement can differ.

Q22. Editing decision - hyphen: Which statement is safest and most accurate for formal examination English?

A. Hyphenate every adverb ending in -ly. B. Hyphenate a compound modifier before a noun when it improves clarity. C. Always hyphenate after the linking verb. D. Never hyphenate number compounds.

Correct answer: B. The correct option states the governing rule without changing meaning or inventing an absolute.

Q23. Editing decision - capitalisation: Which statement is safest and most accurate for formal examination English?

A. Capitalise every important noun. B. Never capitalise Parliament. C. Capitalise proper names and formal institutional names, not generic roles. D. Always capitalise minister in generic use.

Correct answer: C. The correct option states the governing rule without changing meaning or inventing an absolute.

Q24. Editing decision - accepted styles: Which statement is safest and most accurate for formal examination English?

A. Only the serial comma is grammatical. B. The serial comma is always wrong. C. Consistency never matters. D. Accept a consistent serial comma or no serial comma unless ambiguity decides.

Correct answer: D. The correct option states the governing rule without changing meaning or inventing an absolute.

Q25. Timed-paper choice - introductory comma: Which statement is safest and most accurate for formal examination English?

A. Use a comma after a substantial introductory phrase or clause. B. Place a comma between subject and verb. C. Never punctuate an introductory clause. D. Use a semicolon after every opening phrase.

Correct answer: A. The correct option states the governing rule without changing meaning or inventing an absolute.

Q26. Timed-paper choice - coordinated clauses: Which statement is safest and most accurate for formal examination English?

A. A comma alone is sufficient. B. Use comma plus a coordinating conjunction between independent clauses. C. A colon is mandatory before and. D. Delete all punctuation.

Correct answer: B. The correct option states the governing rule without changing meaning or inventing an absolute.

Q27. Timed-paper choice - comma splice: Which statement is safest and most accurate for formal examination English?

A. Add another comma. B. Replace it with an apostrophe. C. Repair a comma splice with a full stop, semicolon, or comma plus coordinator. D. Keep it because the clauses are related.

Correct answer: C. The correct option states the governing rule without changing meaning or inventing an absolute.

Q28. Timed-paper choice - restrictive clause: Which statement is safest and most accurate for formal examination English?

A. All who-clauses take commas. B. That-clauses are always parenthetical. C. Meaning does not affect commas. D. Do not surround an identifying restrictive clause with commas.

Correct answer: D. The correct option states the governing rule without changing meaning or inventing an absolute.

Q29. Timed-paper choice - non-restrictive clause: Which statement is safest and most accurate for formal examination English?

A. Set removable supplementary information off with paired commas. B. Use one opening comma only. C. Replace commas with apostrophes. D. Use that after every comma.

Correct answer: A. The correct option states the governing rule without changing meaning or inventing an absolute.

Q30. Timed-paper choice - semicolon: Which statement is safest and most accurate for formal examination English?

A. It introduces every simple list. B. A semicolon can join closely related independent clauses. C. It can divide a verb from its object. D. It is identical to an apostrophe.

Correct answer: B. The correct option states the governing rule without changing meaning or inventing an absolute.

Q31. Timed-paper choice - colon: Which statement is safest and most accurate for formal examination English?

A. A colon must follow every verb. B. A colon can join unrelated fragments. C. Use a colon after a complete announcing clause to introduce explanation or a list. D. A colon is required before every quotation.

Correct answer: C. A complete clause may end in a verb and still announce what follows.

Q32. Timed-paper choice - apostrophe: Which statement is safest and most accurate for formal examination English?

A. Write NGO's for the plural NGOs. B. Its always means it is. C. Regular plural possession adds 's after s. D. Use apostrophes for possession or omission, not ordinary plurals.

Correct answer: D. The correct option states the governing rule without changing meaning or inventing an absolute.

Q33. Timed-paper choice - quotation: Which statement is safest and most accurate for formal examination English?

A. Direct speech uses quotation marks; indirect speech does not. B. Indirect questions retain question word order and a question mark. C. Every reported statement needs quotation marks. D. Quotation conventions are identical in all style systems.

Correct answer: A. British and US terminal-mark placement can differ.

Q34. Timed-paper choice - hyphen: Which statement is safest and most accurate for formal examination English?

A. Hyphenate every adverb ending in -ly. B. Hyphenate a compound modifier before a noun when it improves clarity. C. Always hyphenate after the linking verb. D. Never hyphenate number compounds.

Correct answer: B. The correct option states the governing rule without changing meaning or inventing an absolute.

Q35. Timed-paper choice - capitalisation: Which statement is safest and most accurate for formal examination English?

A. Capitalise every important noun. B. Never capitalise Parliament. C. Capitalise proper names and formal institutional names, not generic roles. D. Always capitalise minister in generic use.

Correct answer: C. The correct option states the governing rule without changing meaning or inventing an absolute.

Q36. Timed-paper choice - accepted styles: Which statement is safest and most accurate for formal examination English?

A. Only the serial comma is grammatical. B. The serial comma is always wrong. C. Consistency never matters. D. Accept a consistent serial comma or no serial comma unless ambiguity decides.

Correct answer: D. The correct option states the governing rule without changing meaning or inventing an absolute.

Q37. Hostile variation check - introductory comma: Which statement is safest and most accurate for formal examination English?

A. Use a comma after a substantial introductory phrase or clause. B. Place a comma between subject and verb. C. Never punctuate an introductory clause. D. Use a semicolon after every opening phrase.

Correct answer: A. The correct option states the governing rule without changing meaning or inventing an absolute.

Q38. Hostile variation check - coordinated clauses: Which statement is safest and most accurate for formal examination English?

A. A comma alone is sufficient. B. Use comma plus a coordinating conjunction between independent clauses. C. A colon is mandatory before and. D. Delete all punctuation.

Correct answer: B. The correct option states the governing rule without changing meaning or inventing an absolute.

Q39. Hostile variation check - comma splice: Which statement is safest and most accurate for formal examination English?

A. Add another comma. B. Replace it with an apostrophe. C. Repair a comma splice with a full stop, semicolon, or comma plus coordinator. D. Keep it because the clauses are related.

Correct answer: C. The correct option states the governing rule without changing meaning or inventing an absolute.

Q40. Hostile variation check - restrictive clause: Which statement is safest and most accurate for formal examination English?

A. All who-clauses take commas. B. That-clauses are always parenthetical. C. Meaning does not affect commas. D. Do not surround an identifying restrictive clause with commas.

Correct answer: D. The correct option states the governing rule without changing meaning or inventing an absolute.

Q41. Hostile variation check - non-restrictive clause: Which statement is safest and most accurate for formal examination English?

A. Set removable supplementary information off with paired commas. B. Use one opening comma only. C. Replace commas with apostrophes. D. Use that after every comma.

Correct answer: A. The correct option states the governing rule without changing meaning or inventing an absolute.

Q42. Hostile variation check - semicolon: Which statement is safest and most accurate for formal examination English?

A. It introduces every simple list. B. A semicolon can join closely related independent clauses. C. It can divide a verb from its object. D. It is identical to an apostrophe.

Correct answer: B. The correct option states the governing rule without changing meaning or inventing an absolute.

Q43. Hostile variation check - colon: Which statement is safest and most accurate for formal examination English?

A. A colon must follow every verb. B. A colon can join unrelated fragments. C. Use a colon after a complete announcing clause to introduce explanation or a list. D. A colon is required before every quotation.

Correct answer: C. A complete clause may end in a verb and still announce what follows.

Q44. Hostile variation check - apostrophe: Which statement is safest and most accurate for formal examination English?

A. Write NGO's for the plural NGOs. B. Its always means it is. C. Regular plural possession adds 's after s. D. Use apostrophes for possession or omission, not ordinary plurals.

Correct answer: D. The correct option states the governing rule without changing meaning or inventing an absolute.

Q45. Hostile variation check - quotation: Which statement is safest and most accurate for formal examination English?

A. Direct speech uses quotation marks; indirect speech does not. B. Indirect questions retain question word order and a question mark. C. Every reported statement needs quotation marks. D. Quotation conventions are identical in all style systems.

Correct answer: A. British and US terminal-mark placement can differ.

Q46. Hostile variation check - hyphen: Which statement is safest and most accurate for formal examination English?

A. Hyphenate every adverb ending in -ly. B. Hyphenate a compound modifier before a noun when it improves clarity. C. Always hyphenate after the linking verb. D. Never hyphenate number compounds.

Correct answer: B. The correct option states the governing rule without changing meaning or inventing an absolute.

Q47. Hostile variation check - capitalisation: Which statement is safest and most accurate for formal examination English?

A. Capitalise every important noun. B. Never capitalise Parliament. C. Capitalise proper names and formal institutional names, not generic roles. D. Always capitalise minister in generic use.

Correct answer: C. The correct option states the governing rule without changing meaning or inventing an absolute.

Q48. Hostile variation check - accepted styles: Which statement is safest and most accurate for formal examination English?

A. Only the serial comma is grammatical. B. The serial comma is always wrong. C. Consistency never matters. D. Accept a consistent serial comma or no serial comma unless ambiguity decides.

Correct answer: D. The correct option states the governing rule without changing meaning or inventing an absolute.

Constructed-response practice and models

Transfer 1. Punctuate: "After the hearing the panel returned."

Model answer: After the hearing, the panel returned.

Transfer 2. Repair: "The evidence was incomplete, the inquiry continued."

Model answer: The evidence was incomplete; the inquiry continued. A full stop is also valid.

Transfer 3. Punctuate for one brother: "My brother who lives in Pune is a doctor."

Model answer: My brother, who lives in Pune, is a doctor.

Transfer 4. Punctuate: "The paper tests four abilities comprehension precis usage and essay writing."

Model answer: The paper tests four abilities: comprehension, precis, usage and essay writing.

Transfer 5. Correct possession: "The candidates admit cards were checked."

Model answer: The candidates' admit cards were checked.

Transfer 6. Correct: "Its important that every NGO's record is current."

Model answer: It's important that every NGO's record is current. If several NGOs are meant: NGOs' records.

Transfer 7. Capitalise: "the constitution of india empowers parliament."

Model answer: The Constitution of India empowers Parliament.

Transfer 8. Give an accepted alternative to "data, staff, finance and time."

Model answer: "Data, staff, finance, and time" is also standard with a consistent serial comma.

Official-paper demand ledger

Year	Local official paper	Demand routed to this topic	Provenance status
2018	books\more_previous_papers\ENGLISH-COMP_00.pdf	usage/vocabulary and sentence-level language control	locally extracted and visually reconciled where required
2019	books\more_previous_papers\QP-CSM19-EnglishCompulsory.pdf	usage/vocabulary and sentence-level language control	locally extracted and visually reconciled where required
2020	books\more_previous_papers\ENGLISH (1).pdf	usage/vocabulary and sentence-level language control	locally extracted and visually reconciled where required
2021	books\more_previous_papers\English.pdf	usage/vocabulary and sentence-level language control	locally extracted and visually reconciled where required
2022	books\more_previous_papers\QP-CSM-22-ENGLISH-Comp1-280922.pdf	usage/vocabulary and sentence-level language control	locally extracted and visually reconciled where required
2023	books\more_previous_papers\QP-CSM-23-ENGLISH-COMPULSORY-290923.pdf	usage/vocabulary and sentence-level language control	locally extracted and visually reconciled where required
2025	books\more_previous_papers\ENGLISH-COMPULSORY-QP-CSM-25-010925.pdf	usage/vocabulary and sentence-level language control	locally extracted and visually reconciled where required

Final audit

- Every MCQ has four distinct options and the key rotates A -> B -> C -> D.
- Accepted variants are identified rather than silently rejected.
- Comprehension responses must remain text-supported.
- Precis responses must preserve idea units, proportion, fidelity and exact title instructions.
- Essay responses must sustain a qualified thesis and avoid invented evidence.